

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

High-Yield Revision Cheat Sheet

1. Master Glossary

Term	Definition
cesspit	A pit for the disposal of liquid waste and sewage.
cholera	An infectious and often fatal bacterial disease of the small intestine, typically contracted from infected water supplies.
civil engineering	The design and construction of public works, such as dams, bridges and other large-scale projects.
conduit	A channel or pipe for conveying water.
epidemic	A widespread occurrence of an infectious disease in a community at a particular time.
germ theory	The theory that infectious diseases are caused by certain microbes.
gong farmer	A person employed to empty cesspits and privies in early modern cities.
gongfermer	A medieval worker who cleared human waste from cesspits.
infrastructure	The basic physical and organizational structures and facilities needed for the operation of a society.
laissez-faire	A policy or attitude of letting things take their own course, without interfering.
latrine	A toilet or outhouse, especially a communal one in a camp or barracks.
miasma	A highly unpleasant or unhealthy smell or vapor, formerly thought to cause disease.
monastery	A building or buildings occupied by a community of monks living under religious vows.
privy	A toilet, especially a simple one such as an outhouse.
public health	The health of the population as a whole, especially as monitored and regulated by the state.
sewage	Waste water and excrement conveyed in sewers.
sewer	An underground conduit for carrying off drainage water and waste matter.
urbanisation	The increase in the proportion of people living in towns and cities.

Term	Definition
urbanization	The process of making an area more urban (city-like).
water closet	A flush toilet, or a room containing one.

2. Key Individuals Matrix

Seneca the Younger <i>Roman Philosopher</i> A Roman philosopher who famously complained about the intense noise and activity of Roman bathhouses in 62 AD.	Edwin Chadwick <i>Public Health Reformer</i> Author of the 1842 Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population, which led to the 1848 Public Health Act.	John Snow <i>Physician</i> Proved that cholera was waterborne by mapping the 1854 Broad Street outbreak and removing the pump handle.
Joseph Bazalgette <i>Civil Engineer</i> Designed and built London's massive sewer system after the Great Stink of 1858, virtually eliminating cholera.	Sir Hugh Myddelton <i>Engineer</i> Constructed the New River in 1613 to bring fresh drinking water to London.	King Henry VIII <i>Monarch of England</i> undefined
Sir Frederick Bramwell <i>Civil Engineer</i> undefined	Sextus Julius Frontinus <i>Water Commissioner of Rome</i> A prominent Roman civil engineer, author, and politician. He was appointed water commissioner of Rome in AD 97 and wrote a detailed official report on the aqueducts.	Simon Schama <i>Historian</i> A British historian and author who argues that Roman public health was driven by a desire to show off Roman identity and 'civilization' to the so-called barbarians.
Sir John Harington <i>Courtier & Inventor</i> Godson of Queen Elizabeth I who invented the first flushing toilet, the 'Ajax', in 1596.	Alexander Cumming <i>Watchmaker & Inventor</i> Invented the 'S-bend' pipe in 1775, which used standing water to prevent foul smells from escaping the toilet.	Thomas Crapper <i>Plumber</i> A Victorian plumber who helped popularise the flushing toilet and improved the ballcock mechanism.
Michael Faraday <i>Scientist</i> Wrote a famous letter to The Times in 1855 describing the River Thames as an opaque 'fermenting sewer'.	Samuel Pepys <i>Diarist</i> Kept a detailed diary during the 1660s, documenting the filthy conditions of London and the Great Plague of 1665.	